

to add an additional 512 MB of DDR RAM. Will it be OK for me to add an additional 512 MB of 266 MHz DDR RAM, parallel to the existing 256 MB?

Juzar

A You will definitely be able to install an additional 512 MB DDR memory module. Keep in mind, though, that the motherboard supports up to 2 GB of 200 MHz or 266 MHz DDR RAM only. We would like to advise that you install a RAM stick of the same speed as the one already in place, in order to avoid any further problems.

Q I want to buy a DVD/Combo writer for backing up my data. Can you suggest a good one? I need a drive with 52X writing speed and 16X DVD writing speed.

Dr V K Saxena

A Typically, a combo drive costs between Rs 2,500 and Rs 2,950 depending on the brand. Consider Lite-On, Sony, Asus or BenQ. Buy DVD-writers if your data set is going to be larger, above 1 GB. Or buy a 16X DVD-Writer too, but right now, DVD media availability is an issue. DVD-writers will cost upwards of Rs 4,500.

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.26 GHz and a Mercury motherboard with two memory slots. Each slot can hold a 1 GB RAM stick. There's 128 MB DDR RAM installed in one slot. I would like to install a 256 MB stick in the vacant slot. I want to know whether there would be a problem if I have two memory slots with memory modules of different capacities?

Goutam Ghosh

A There should be no problem with putting in RAM modules of different capacities. However, you might encounter problems if the RAM frequencies are different. If you would like to check your RAM frequencies, download a software called Everest from www.lavalys.com. Insert one module at a time and check for